

NIS2 Readiness Checklist

A 5-minute self-assessment for UK SMEs (10–100 employees)

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NIS2 is the EU's updated cybersecurity directive. UK companies are in scope if they sell into the EU or sit in the supply chain of an EU-regulated business. Tick each item you can honestly answer 'yes' to.

- ☐ **Risk assessment** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(a)
We have a documented, up-to-date assessment of our key cyber risks.
- ☐ **Incident response plan** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(b)
We have a written plan for handling a security incident — and staff know it exists.
- ☐ **Incident reporting** NIS2 Art. 23
We could report a significant incident to authorities within 24 hours.
- ☐ **Business continuity** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(c)
We have tested backups and know how long recovery would take after ransomware.
- ☐ **Supply chain security** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(d)
We assess the security of our key suppliers and IT service providers.
- ☐ **Vulnerability management** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(e)
We patch systems on a defined schedule and scan for vulnerabilities.
- ☐ **Access control & MFA** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(i)(j)
Multi-factor authentication is enforced on email, VPN and admin accounts.
- ☐ **Encryption** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(h)
Sensitive data is encrypted at rest and in transit (laptops, backups, email).
- ☐ **Security training** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(g)
All staff receive cybersecurity awareness training at least annually.
- ☐ **Management accountability** NIS2 Art. 20
Company leadership formally approves and reviews our security measures.
- ☐ **Network monitoring** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(b)
We would notice unusual activity on our network (logs, alerts, IDS).
- ☐ **Policies & documentation** NIS2 Art. 21(2)(f)
Our security policies are written down — not just 'in someone's head'.

Your score

10–12 ticks: Strong position — keep your documentation current.

6–9 ticks: Partial readiness — gaps here are what regulators and clients ask about first.

0–5 ticks: Exposed — a structured gap analysis should be your next step.

Not sure where you stand?

Book a free 15-minute NIS2 exposure check — no pitch, just clarity on whether NIS2 affects your business.

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